

SACS Alumni Hub

Alumni Platform Proposal

Prepared for: SACS Old Boys Union Committee

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A modern, purpose-built alumni platform
for the SACS Old Boys community.

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This proposal is confidential and intended solely for the SACS Old Boys Union.

1. Introduction

The SACS Alumni Hub is a modern, purpose-built digital platform designed exclusively for the SACS Old Boys community. As a SACS Old Boy and Computer Science student at Stellenbosch University, I have built this platform from the ground up to serve our alumni network with the tools it needs — a searchable member directory, community feed, direct messaging, events, jobs board, business directory, mentoring, and more.

This proposal outlines how the SACS Alumni Hub can replace the current AlumNet service with a more feature-rich, modern platform at a significantly lower cost — while keeping all existing alumni data intact through a managed migration.

Why SACS Alumni Hub?

- **Built by a SACS Old Boy** — I understand the community because I'm part of it. Changes and requests go directly to the person who built the platform, not through a support queue.
- **More features, lower cost** — The platform already includes 24 integrated features (see Section 3), far exceeding the standard AlumNet offering, at roughly 30% less per month.
- **Modern technology** — Built on industry-leading infrastructure (Supabase, Vercel, React) that is fast, secure, and scales effortlessly. Real-time updates, interactive maps, and a mobile-friendly design throughout.
- **Full data ownership** — All alumni data belongs exclusively to the SACS OBU. Data can be exported at any time in standard formats. No lock-in.
- **Dedicated support** — Direct line to the developer. No ticket queues, no waiting for "next business day" responses on minor requests.

2. What's Included

Platform & Hosting

The full SACS Alumni Hub web application, hosted on Vercel with a custom domain (e.g. sacsalumni.org). Fast, reliable, and accessible from any device — desktop, tablet, or phone.

Database & Authentication

Secure cloud database on Supabase with row-level security on every table. Members sign up with email/password or Google, and are verified by an admin before gaining access.

Data Migration

Full migration of your existing alumni data from AlumNet. I will convert the Excel export into the new system, map all profile fields (name, grad year, contact details, occupation, address, Old Boy status, parent/staff flags, etc.), and clean the data during import.

Email Communications

Integrated email service (Resend) for transactional emails (welcome, approval, password reset) and bulk communications to the alumni base. Up to 50,000 emails per month included.

Ongoing Support & Maintenance

Unlimited email and WhatsApp support. Bug fixes, feature updates, and platform improvements included at no extra charge. Direct access to the developer — no intermediaries.

Training

Online walkthrough of the admin panel and all platform features. Written documentation for ongoing reference.

3. Feature Comparison

The table below compares the features available on the SACS Alumni Hub against the standard AlumNet package currently in use.

Feature	SACS Alumni Hub	AlumNet Standard
Member directory with search & filters	✓	✓
Interactive alumni map (worldwide)	✓	✗
Community feed (posts, images, likes, comments)	✓	✗
Direct messaging (real-time)	✓	✗
Events calendar with RSVP	✓	✓
Jobs board	✓	✗
Business directory	✓	✗
Mentoring system	✓	✗
Merch / online shop	✓	✓
Notable Old Boys showcase	✓	✗
Photo albums	✓	✗
Badges & achievements	✓	✗
Global search	✓	✗
Who's online / presence	✓	✗
Admin panel (approvals, reports, analytics)	✓	✓
Bulk email communications	✓	✓
Mobile-responsive design	✓	✓
Real-time notifications	✓	✗
Privacy controls per member	✓	~
Profile detail fields (DOB, ID, school info)	✓	✓
SMS credits	✗	✓
Custom subdomain	✓	✓

Note: SMS credits are not currently included but can be added as an optional extra if required.

4. Pricing

Simple, transparent pricing with no hidden costs. All prices exclude VAT.

SET-UP FEE R5,000 once-off	MONTHLY FEE R1,800 per month
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What's included in the set-up fee:

- Platform configuration and deployment to your custom domain
- Full data migration from AlumNet (Excel import, field mapping, data cleaning)
- Admin account setup and initial training session
- Email service configuration and domain verification

What's included in the monthly fee:

- Platform hosting (Vercel) and database (Supabase)
- Up to 50,000 emails per month (bulk + transactional)
- Unlimited email and WhatsApp support
- All software updates, bug fixes, and new features
- Data backups and security maintenance

Cost comparison: AlumNet charges R25,000 set-up + R2,500/month (standard) or R5,500/month (premium). Over 12 months, AlumNet standard costs **R55,000**. SACS Alumni Hub costs **R26,600** — a saving of **R28,400 in the first year** (52% less), with more features included.

5. Data Migration Plan

Transitioning from AlumNet is straightforward. Under AlumNet's contract terms, all member data belongs exclusively to the SACS OBU and will be provided in Excel format upon cancellation. I will handle the complete migration:

- **Step 1 — Data handover:** Request the full alumni database export from AlumNet in Excel format.
- **Step 2 — Field mapping:** Map every AlumNet field (File Number, Title, Known As, Initials, First Name, Last Name, Surname at School, Email, Date of Birth, ID Number, Nationality, Phone numbers, Address, Class Of, Old Boy status, Parent/Staff flags, Industry, Occupation, LinkedIn, Communication preferences) to the corresponding SACS Alumni Hub database columns.
- **Step 3 — Data cleaning:** Standardise formats (dates, phone numbers, addresses), remove duplicates, and flag incomplete records for review.
- **Step 4 — Import & verification:** Bulk import into the platform. Each migrated member receives an email invitation to claim their account and set a password.
- **Step 5 — Parallel run (optional):** If desired, both systems can run side-by-side for a short transition period to ensure nothing is lost.

The migration covers all existing records — both members who have signed up for the portal and contact-only records used for email communications. The email mailing list will be fully preserved.

6. Terms & Timeline

Timeline

The platform is already built and live. Once the data export is received from AlumNet, migration and launch can be completed within **2 weeks**.

Phase	Duration	Details
Agreement signed	Day 0	Confirm scope and request AlumNet data export
Data migration	Days 1–7	Import, clean, and verify alumni records
Configuration	Days 1–7	Domain setup, email service, admin accounts
Testing & training	Days 8–12	Admin walkthrough, verify data, test email sends
Go live	Day 14	Switch DNS, send launch announcement to alumni

Terms

- All prices exclude VAT.
- No minimum contract period — cancel with 30 days' written notice.
- All alumni data belongs exclusively to the SACS OBU at all times.
- Upon cancellation, all data will be exported and delivered in Excel/CSV format at no charge.
- Monthly fee is payable by the 1st of each month via EFT.
- Set-up fee is payable upon agreement, before migration begins.
- This quote is valid for 60 days from the date of this proposal.

Data Protection

The platform uses industry-standard security practices: encrypted connections (HTTPS/TLS), row-level security on every database table, secure authentication, and regular backups. Member data is never shared with third parties and is used only to operate the alumni platform.

7. Next Steps

I would welcome the opportunity to demo the platform and discuss how it can serve the SACS Old Boys community. Here's what happens next:

- **Live demo** — I'll walk through every feature of the platform so the committee can see it in action.
- **Questions & customisation** — Any specific requirements or changes the OBU needs can be discussed and scoped.
- **Agreement** — If the committee is happy to proceed, we sign off and I begin the data migration immediately.
- **Launch** — Within two weeks, the SACS Alumni Hub is live and serving the Old Boys community.

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